# Vikas PD Gawai


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**Employment**

Postdoctoral Health Economics Research Fellow, Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (CDC) 2024–Present

**Education**

PhD, Applied Economics, University of Wisconsin-Madison 2018–2024
Dissertation: "Technology in the Aging World: The Role of Broadband and Green Revolution"
Committee: Jeremy Foltz, Lauren Schmitz, John Mullahy, Jason Fletcher, Priya Mukherjee
MS, Economics, University of Wisconsin-Madison 2016–2018
Bachelor of Technology, Civil Engineering, Mumbai University 2004–2008

**Publications**

- **Vikas Gawai**. (2026). "Does high-speed internet (broadband) technology affect the mental health of older adults?" *Conditionally Accepted*.
- Sergey Sotnikov, Kelly Kilburn, **Vikas Gawai**, Nancy Habarta, Cassandra Frazier, and Karen Mumford. (2026). "CDC's Preventive Health and Health Services Block Grant flexible funding mechanism is associated with improved population health outcomes." *Journal of Public Health Management and Practice* (Forthcoming).
- **Vikas Gawai** and Steven Deller. (2025). "Is there a link between access to broadband and health outcomes?" *American Journal of Economics and Sociology*.
- Jeremy Foltz and **Vikas Gawai**. (2025). "Discrimination in science: Salaries of foreign and U.S.-born land-grant university scientists." *American Journal of Agricultural Economics*.
- Hamid Noghanibehambari, Jason Fletcher, Lauren Schmitz, Valentina Duque, and **Vikas Gawai**. (2024). "Early-life economic conditions and old-age male mortality: evidence from historical county-level bank deposit data." *Journal of Population Economics*.

**Research Under External / Internal Review**

- **Vikas Gawai**, Nancy Habarta, Ruth Gould, Sergey Sotnikov, Kristen Chapman, Caroline Sulal, Karla Checo Martinez, Hazel Dean, and Ermias Belay. (2026). "Cost efficiency of a centralized funding mechanism: Evi-

dence from CDC's National Partnership umbrella cooperative agreement."

- **Vikas Gawai**, Jessica Irizarry, Megan Harbour, Camila Rodriguez-Rojas, Hazel Dean, and Ermias Belay. (2026). "Cost efficiency analysis of CDC's centralized funding mechanism using a stochastic frontier approach: Evidence from CDC's U.S. Affiliated Pacific Islands Cooperative Agreement."
- **Vikas Gawai**, Lauren Schmitz, Valentina Duque, and Jinkook Lee. "Effect of early life exposure to the Green Revolution on aging outcomes in India."
- Kanika Arora, Shubhashrita Basu, **Vikas Gawai**, Junjie Gai, and Lauren Schmitz. "Cognitive function and life-course patterns – Evidence from the Longitudinal Aging Study of India."

## Working Papers

- **Vikas Gawai**, Sergey Sotnikov, Nancy Habarta, Sonal Doshi, ShauntÄ Wright, Katherine Butler Smart, Donatus U. Ekwueme, "Association between CDC's Preventive Health and Health Services Block Grant public health infrastructure investments and performance of state public health departments."
- Adrienne Gill, **Vikas Gawai**, Hannah McMillan, Deborah Bryant, Nancy Habarta, and Hazel Dean. "Association between CDC's accreditation funding and performance of state health departments."
- Donatus U. Ekwueme, **Vikas Gawai**, Sabitha Dasari, Yamisha Bermudez, Sun Hee Rim, Susan Sabatino, Janet S. de Moor, David A. Siegel, Michael T. Halpern, K. Robin Yobroff. "The evolving economic burden of cancer survivors in the United States, 2011-2024."
- **Vikas Gawai**. "Spillover effects of a bicycle policy on girls' enrollment in middle schools." (Best Research Paper, Honorable Mention)
- **Vikas Gawai**. "Effects of Teacher Hiring Policy on Students' Learning in Rural India: A Multi-Cutoff Regression Discontinuity Design Approach."
- **Vikas Gawai**. "Does Broadband Technology Affect Social Security Applications?"

## Media & Impact

Internet and Mental Health, GROW Magazine Cover Story
Broadband and Social Security Applications, The Financial Findings Podcast

## Technical Skills

Stata, R, Python, LaTeX, GitHub, AI Agents, MS Office

## Grants, Fellowships & Awards

Diversity Fellow, School of Public Affairs, American University 2023–2024

Research Fellow, Retirement and Disability Research Center (RDRC) 2022–2024
Center for Demography of Health and Aging Research ($2,000) 2023
RDRC - Junior Scholar Research Competition Award ($5,000) 2022
Research Travel Award UW-Madison ($1,100) 2022
Deborah and David Penn Fund ($1,500) 2022–2023
UW-Madison Graduate School Award ($4,000) 2022–2023
UW-Madison Center for Demography and Ecology ($950) 2022
DEI Diversity Scholarship, American Society of Health Economics (ASHEcon) 2021
UW-Madison Traisman Agribusiness Graduate Fellowship ($750) 2021
UW-Madison Student Research Grants Competition ($1,500) 2020
UW-Madison IRIS Graduate Student Summer Fieldwork Award ($3,000) 2019
Best Research Scholarship (Honorable Mention), UW-Madison Dept. of Economics 2018
Indian State Government Scholarship for MS Economics ($100,000) 2016–2018

## Teaching & Research Experience

**Research Assistantships**

Prof. Lauren Schmitz (UW-Madison, School of Public Affairs) 2020–2024
Prof. Jeremy Foltz (UW-Madison, Agriculture and Applied Economics) 2018–2020
Prof. Andra Ghent (UW-Madison, Wisconsin School of Business) 2018

**Teaching**

Econometrics Methods at CDC (CDC) 2026
Guest Lecturer, World Hunger and Malnutrition (UW-Madison) 2024
Guest Lecturer, Gender Gap and Economic Development (UW-Madison) 2022–2023
Guest Lecturer, Agricultural & Economic Development of Africa (UW-Madison) 2022
Guest Lecturer, The Economics of Race and Gender (Bentley University) 2022

## Professional Service & Leadership

**Editorial & Review**

Associate Editor: *Preventing Chronic Disease* 2026–Present
Reviewer: *International Journal of Public Health* (2026), *Journal of Population Economics* (2025, 2026), Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management (2023, 2025), Agriculture and Applied Economics Association (2022–2024), *Economics of Education Review* (2022–2023), American Society for Health Economists (2022)

**Institutional Service**

CDC Prevention Effectiveness Fellowship Hiring Committee 2025–2026

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| AAEA-Health Economics Section Official Twitter Manager | 2022–2023 |
| UW-Madison AAE Faculty Hiring Committee | 2022 |
| UW-Madison AAE Ph.D. Admission Committee | 2021 |
| Taylor-Hibbard Club, Athletic Chair | 2020–2022 |
| UW-Madison AAE Development Lab Group | 2019 |

**Mentorship**

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| UW-Madison CDHA Research Mentor for 18 students | 2022 |
| Undergraduate Research Supervisor (2 students) | 2022 |
| Mentor, First-generation undergraduate students | 2022 |
| Mentor, First-generation underrepresented graduate students from India | 2018–Present |

## Conferences

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| AcademyHealth | 2026 |
| ASHEcon | 2024 |
| Social Security Administration (SSA) Annual Meeting | 2024 |
| Data-Intensive Research Conference, University of Minnesota | 2024 |
| Midwest Economics Association | 2023 |
| Southern Economics Association | 2023 |
| Agricultural and Applied Economics Association | 2022 |
| Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management | 2022–2024 |
| Population Association of America | 2022 |
| American Education Finance and Policy Conference | 2020 |

## References

**Jeremy Foltz**
Agriculture and Applied Economics
University of Wisconsin-Madison
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**Nancy Habarta**
CDC
NHabarta@cdc.gov

**Lauren Schmitz**
La Follette School of Public Affairs
University of Wisconsin-Madison
llschmitz@wisc.edu

**Donatus U. (Don) Ekwueme**
CDC
dce3@cdc.gov

(Updated October 15, 2026)